only be used either for self-defence or in pursuance of a decision made collectively by the members of UNO. In other words, the UN Charter is the embodiment (earlier the Covenant was) of protection and safeguard of international peace and security.

Various Conventions and Declarations also try to safeguard human life and dignity such as the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948), the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (1966), the International Covenant on Economic Social and Cultural Rights (1966), the Convention on Genocide (1948).

2. *Protection of Human Life in War:* Moral limitations are also imposed during times of war by various Conventions and Declarations. In Chapter IV, Book III of *On the Law of War and Peace*, under the heading "On the Right of Killing Enemies in a Public War and on Other Violence against the Person", Grotius presented a catalogue of acts of violence committed in ancient history against enemy persons without discrimination. He himself justified some on the ground that the war was waged for a just cause. Since then the whole concept of war has undergone change and it is now accepted that war is not a contest between whole populations, but only between the armies of the belligerent states. Therefore, a distinction between combatants and non-combatants became fundamental legal and moral principles governing war. These found expressions in the Hague Conventions, with respect to the *Laws and Customs of War on Land* of 1899 and 1907 and the Geneva Conventions of 1864 superseded by those of 1906, 1929 and 1949, and their additional Protocols. The International Red Cross Society (ICRC) is entrusted with the mandate to uphold the International Humanitarian Law.

3. *Moral Condemnation of War:* There is increasing realization on the part of the states that use of war as an instrument of foreign policy is restricted by certain moral limitations. The two Hague Conferences of 1899 and 1907, the League of Nations (1919), the Kellog–Briand Pact of 1928—all outlaw aggressive war, and the United Nations (1946) upholds the avoidance of war as its ultimate objective. War in the present has assumed perilous proportions due to the advent of newer technologies and nuclear materials resulting